

Far Dreaming

The Far Dreaming is the second Dreaming plane and is a realm that reflects myths, dreams, and ideas that are centuries, if not millennia, old. Some locations are even from long before the Shattering, and while they're rare, Kithain know they exist and hold a great many clues as to what happened during the cataclysmic events. These hidden places survived because the Far Dreaming lacks the direct attunement that the Near Dreaming has to the mundane plane.

Trods of the Silver Path type remains the safest way to travel, but due to the toll the Shattering took on the Dreaming, most are weak, causing the protection spell to end mid-road. It's due to this and the presence of the Firchlís that changelings find it impossible to chart the Far Dreaming. Mutations constantly shift connection points between realms, meaning that wayfarers have to successfully plan their path there. That said, a few stable trods exist that brings travelers to the famous Vale of Mists.

In order to access the Far Dreaming, travelers end up traveling through the Vale of Mists. The Vale of Mists connects the Near and Far Dreaming (but is actually part of the latter). It's a vast landscape with foggy forests, peaceful lakes, and small farming communities. Before the Resurgence, the location was one of the few really stable locations in the Dreaming that reminded the fae of the beauty of Arcadia, and the peacefulness it instilled in their souls. Many Kithain constructed workshops, taverns, and inns in the area, making it popular with changelings and sentient chimera tourists looking to escape the mundane for a while. Sadly, the repeated visitors from the Autumn world made the area respond fearfully to their Banality, resulting in darker, vicious chimera and fae controlling certain parts of the realm.

Due to the risk of Bedlam, only the most powerful chimera and changelings are able to set up residence in the Far Dreaming. In fact, some Kithain view the Far Dreaming as a kind of hospice where they go when they can truly no longer bear to return to Earth after experiencing the Dreaming's glory. Such changelings briefly return to their mundane world to say goodbye and settle their affairs, then move into the Dreaming to live out their existence before falling to Bedlam or dying. No matter who decides to live there, they leave an imprint on the chimerical landscape in one way or another, often attracting some of the vast numbers of sentient chimera to live alongside them. Constructing housing often proves a bit easier than in the Near Dreaming due to the surplus of dreamstuff, and because their magic is further empowered on this plane.

While it's rare, it's possible to end up in the Far Dreaming without meaning to. This sometimes happens when a mythical beast, such as a dragon or roc, visits the Near Dreaming and grabs the Kithain before returning home with its prey. Another, more unexpected, means of entrance is due to the Firchlís mutating nature, shifting its connection point to one somewhere in the Vale of Mists. Once wayfarers emerge from the Vale, they've truly entered the realms of the Far Dreaming.

Far Dreaming surroundings appear even more vivid and pure than those of the Near Dreaming due to its distance from the

mundane world. No true shades of gray exist in metaphorical terms, so what is a gentle wind elsewhere turns into a howling, flesh-tearing storm. In the same fashion, mountains are larger and grander, and water in the streams shimmers with clarity while containing traces of Glamour.

Encounters in the Far Dreaming appear extremely odd since its distance from the Autumn Realm means that there's little logic to follow while there. Enigmas never take the form of simple mathematical solutions where adding two numbers together equals another one. Instead, the correct reply to a puzzle may not actually be a reply as much as reaction or emotion. This ever-changing logic makes it difficult for Gremayre users to analyze situations, adding +2 difficulty on all such rolls.

In order to enter the Deep Dreaming, travelers have to pass through one of the 13 magical gates that are guarded by traps, creatures, puzzles, and even chimerical memories of ancient sidhe knights with instructions to keep commoners away. As recently as 15 years ago 14 gates stood, but during the Evanesence one location seemingly collapsed and vanished. Its ruins are lost, but the location may contain clues to what happened if someone successfully discovers a trod leading to it.

Example location: Halostian's laboratory

There are legends among the Kithain concerning a renowned diplomat, alchemist, and strategist called Halostian, who lived during the War of Trees. His knowledge was instrumental to bringing down the Dark Dream, and while he later vanished without trace, his laboratory still exists within the Far Dreaming. Nonetheless, getting there is not an easy task, since it requires leaving the Silver Path and journeying on the cursed Dusk Road and through the Pale Swamps before even setting foot in the domain that once belonged to Halostian. What is less known about him is that he pitted his enemies against each other, rarely involving himself in the deeds. His domain is full of traps and mind-twisting poisons, and many adventurers have died at the hands of their friends while attempting to make their way to the unexplored laboratory.

Deep Dreaming

Entering the Deep Dreaming is more complicated than just succeeding at the trials at the magical gates. If a traveler is weighed by Banality (6+) the Dreaming rejects them and treats them as a cancerous infection, sending its chimerical defenses to eradicate the intruders. It's physically impossible for such creatures to set foot inside the Deep Dreaming. Even if a traveler is unburdened by that level of Banality, she must enter on a Silver Path and pass the final trial inside the Mistweir — the final barrier to a realm of pure dreams where landscapes and locations constantly change. In ancient days, the Deep Dreaming was the outer realm of Arcadia, but during the Shattering it turned into the turmoil that the plane is today. Dreams are so intense in the Deep Dreaming that they cannot be controlled or directed. Even those who enter the region through one of the Paths of Balor find themselves at the barrier borders.